

ZOKARIO EDITIONS

The Moon Ferry

*A bedtime tale of leftover dreams and the
quiet ferryman who carries them home*

DIGITAL EDITION · 2026



CONTENTS

I	The Harbour Where the Rooftops End	
II	A Ticket Paid in Wishes	
III	The Lighthouse That Collected Echoes	
IV	Fog, and How to Be Brave in It	
V	The Island of Almost-Morning	
VI	The Ferryman's Lantern	
VII	Home Before the Stars Go Out	

The Harbour Where the Rooftops End

When the last lamp in the last window goes out, a harbour appears where the rooftops end: a small, patient harbour made of mist and moonlight, with one golden boat rocking gently at its pier. The boat belongs to Oto, the quietest ferryman who ever lived. He wears a coat the colour of midnight and a scarf knitted from fog, and he never rings a bell or calls a name. He simply waits, as the tide of stars comes in, for the sky-sea to open its silver road.

Every night, Oto sails from windowsill to windowsill, gathering the dreams the day left behind. Some dreams are small and warm, like a spoonful of honey. Some are wide as summer, smelling of grass and bicycle wind. He lifts each one with careful hands, wraps it in a square of starlight, and lays it in the boat's golden hold. Then he sails on, past chimneys and church towers, to deliver them, one by one, to the children who need them most: the worried ones, the lonely ones, the ones who cannot sleep.

But tonight, something is different. Tonight, at the very bottom of the hold, one small dream is trembling. It is a curled-up, silvery thing, no bigger than a plum, and when Oto reaches for it, it rolls away and hides behind the anchor rope. 'Come now,' he whispers, in his voice like turning pages. 'Somebody is waiting for you.' But the little dream

shakes its silvery head, for dreams can be shy, and this one is the shyest he has ever carried. It will not, will not, will not be delivered.

Oto sits down on the edge of his golden boat and thinks. In all his thousand nights of sailing, no dream has ever refused him. Far below, in a small house at the end of a small street, a child named Mira lies awake with empty hands, waiting for a dream that will not come. And far above, the moon leans closer to watch. Here, little listener, the free crossing ends, and the harbour lantern dims. In the full tale, Oto and the runaway dream sail the whole sky-sea to learn why some dreams are afraid, and how even the shyest one finds its way home.



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